Upwork Job Alert Chrome Extension - Complete PRD

Created: Oct 25, 2026
Target Market: Indian Freelancers on Upwork
Status: Pre-Development Planning

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1. OVERVIEW

What This Extension Does

A real-time Chrome extension that monitors Upwork job feeds, filters jobs based on your skills and preferences, and sends instant notifications when matching jobs appear—so you can apply within the critical 15-30 minute window when most proposals win contracts.

Problem We're Solving

- **Freelancers miss jobs:** By the time you manually refresh Upwork, 20-50 proposals are already submitted
- **Native alerts are slow:** Upwork batches email alerts, you get them hours late
- **RSS is dead:** Upwork removed RSS feeds that freelancers relied on for 3+ years
- **Manual hunting wastes time:** Freelancers spend 2-3 hours daily manually refreshing job feeds
- **High competition:** 15+ million freelancers fighting for same jobs in 2026

Target User

- **Primary:** Indian freelancers on Upwork (beginner to intermediate)
- **Secondary:** Freelancers globally who want faster alerts
- **Use case:** Developers, writers, designers, virtual assistants, data analysts

Why NOW

- Upwork removed RSS in 2025 → users desperate for replacement
- SnipeWork exists but costs $49/month (expensive for India)
- Opportunity: $15-20/month for India = ₹1200-1600/month = 5x cheaper
- Demand proof: 730K+ job scraped by competitors, millions of freelancers need this

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2. PHASE 1: MVP (What We Build First - 2 Weeks)

MVP Goal

Launch a **working extension** that:

- ✅ Scans Upwork every 2-5 minutes (not manually)
- ✅ Sends instant notifications when matching jobs appear
- ✅ Saves 2+ hours daily per freelancer

- ✅ Works without needing backend API (we add API later)
- ✅ Costs under ₹199/month to use

MVP NOT Includes

- ❌ AI job scoring (Phase 2)
- ❌ Proposal generation (Phase 2)
- ❌ Advanced filtering by budget/client rating (Phase 2)
- ❌ Mobile app (Phase 3)
- ❌ Team features (Phase 3)

MVP Success Metrics

- 100+ installs in week 1
- 30+ active users in month 1
- 10+ paid conversions in month 1
- 4.5+ star rating on Chrome Web Store

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3. TECH STACK & ARCHITECTURE

Frontend (Chrome Extension)

```
Technology: HTML5 + CSS3 + Vanilla JavaScript (no frameworks yet)
Version: Manifest V3 (required for Chrome 2026)
Size: <500KB (Chrome extension limit awareness)
Libraries: None initially (keep it light)
```

How It Works (Architecture)

```
1. USER SETS UP
   └─ Installs extension
   └─ Enters Upwork search URL (e.g., "python developer")
   └─ Chooses notification method (desktop or Telegram)

2. EXTENSION MONITORS
   └─ Every 2 minutes: Background script checks Upwork search page
   └─ DOM scraping (parses job titles, budgets, descriptions)
   └─ Stores previous jobs seen
   └─ Compares new jobs vs. old jobs

3. NEW JOB DETECTED
   └─ Checks if job matches user filters
   └─ Sends desktop notification instantly
   └─ Logs job in extension popup (history)

4. USER CLICKS NOTIFICATION
   └─ Opens Upwork job posting in new tab
   └─ User applies manually (for now)
```

Storage

- **Local:** Chrome Storage API (localStorage, IndexedDB)
- **What we store:**
  - User's saved searches
  - Last 100 jobs seen (to avoid duplicate alerts)
  - User notification preferences
  - Applied/skipped jobs (optional tracking)

Backend (Phase 2)

- Not needed for MVP
- Later: Simple Node.js server to improve job scraping reliability

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4. CORE FEATURES (MVP)

Feature 1: Setup Wizard

What it does:

- User opens extension popup
- Enters Upwork search URL (e.g., `upwork.com/search/jobs/?q=python`)
- Selects notification type (Desktop / Desktop + Telegram)

- Sets minimum hourly rate or budget (optional)
- Saves preferences

User flow:

```
Click extension icon → See setup form → Paste Upwork search URL
→ Click "Start Monitoring" → See "Monitoring active" badge
```

Feature 2: Real-Time Job Monitoring

What it does:

- Background script runs every 2 minutes (configurable)
- Visits user's saved Upwork search URL
- Scrapes job titles, budgets, client names
- Compares with previously seen jobs
- Identifies NEW jobs

Technical:

- Chrome `alarms` API for scheduling
- DOM parser for scraping (jQuery-free)
- LocalStorage for job history

Feature 3: Instant Notifications

What it does:

- When new job matches filters → Desktop notification appears
- Notification shows: Job title + Budget + Client
- Click notification → Opens job in new Upwork tab

Example notification:

```
🔔 New Job: Python Backend Developer
💰 $50/hr | 40+ hours
👤 Client: TechStartup (5★)
Click to apply →
```

Feature 4: Job History in Popup

What it does:

- Click extension icon → See all jobs found today
- Shows timestamp, budget, job title
- One-click "Open in Upwork" for each job

- "Mark as Applied" button to track your proposals

Display:

```
📋 Jobs Found Today (12)

[New] Python Developer – $45/hr (2 min ago) 🔗 Apply
[New] Data Analyst – $40/hr (15 min ago) 🔗 Apply
[Seen] React Dev – $50/hr (1 hr ago) Applied ✓

Refresh Now | Settings
```

Feature 5: Settings & Customization

What it does:

- Turn monitoring on/off
- Change refresh interval (2, 5, 10 minutes)
- Set minimum budget filter
- Enable/disable notifications
- View API limits (if using official API later)

Settings screen:

```
⚙️ Extension Settings

Monitoring: [ON/OFF Toggle]
Refresh Every: [2 | 5 | 10] minutes
Minimum Budget: [$30/hr | $40/hr | Any]
Notifications: [Desktop Only | Telegram + Desktop]
Sound: [On/Off]
Log job history: [Yes/No]

Clear Cache | Export Jobs
```

Feature 6: Telegram Integration (MVP with limitation)

What it does:

- User can enable Telegram alerts
- Manual setup: User generates Telegram bot token
- Extension sends basic notification to Telegram chat
- Message: "New Job: [Title] $[Budget]" + Link

Note: Telegram part may require basic backend for Phase 2

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5. FUTURE ROADMAP (Phases 2-4)

Phase 2: Smart Filtering & Backend (Month 2-3)

New features:

- ✅ AI Job Scoring (which jobs are best for YOU)
- ✅ Multi-language support (Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, etc.)
- ✅ Client quality filtering (avoid low-rating clients)
- ✅ Budget range detection (alert if below minimum)
- ✅ Category filtering (dev jobs only, no design, etc.)
- ✅ Reliable backend API (stop relying on DOM scraping)
- ✅ Database storage of job history (across devices)

Technical:

- Simple Node.js + Express backend
- PostgreSQL for job storage
- Better job classification API

Phase 3: AI Proposal Generation (Month 4-5)

New features:

- ✅ AI-powered cover letter generator
- ✅ Auto-fill proposals with your skills
- ✅ One-click apply (with user confirmation)
- ✅ Proposal templates by job category
- ✅ A/B test different proposals

Technical:

- Claude API or OpenAI for text generation
- User profile parsing (skills extraction)

Phase 4: Premium Team Features (Month 6+)

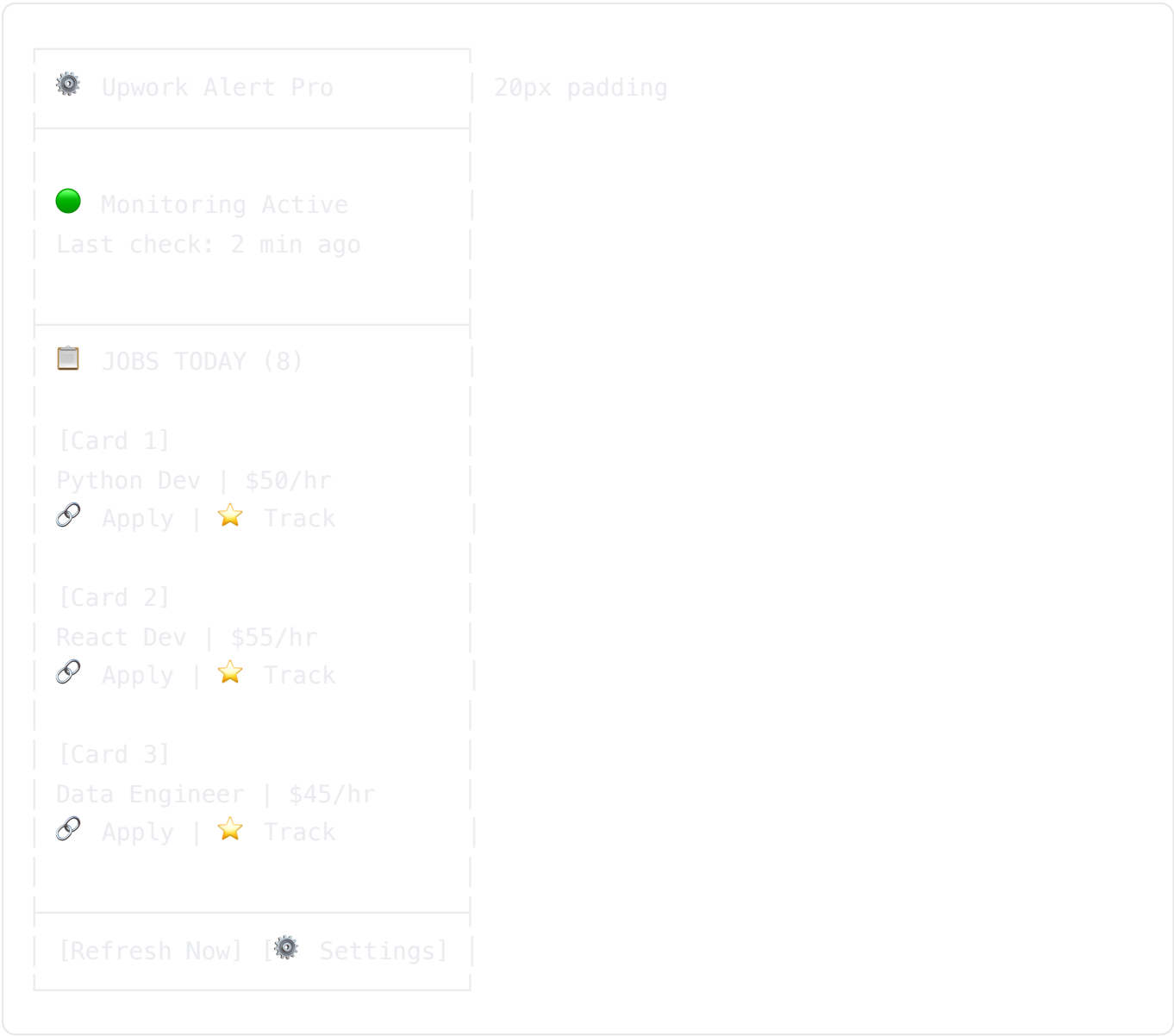
New features:

- ✅ Team management (share searches with team)
- ✅ Advanced analytics (win rate, response time, etc.)
- ✅ Bulk proposal sending
- ✅ CRM integration (track client interactions)
- ✅ Mobile app
- ✅ API for custom integrations

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6. DESIGN & UX

Popup (Main View)



Settings Page



Color Scheme

- **Primary:** `#2563EB` (Blue - Upwork brand)
- **Success:** `#10B981` (Green - "monitoring active")
- **Alert:** `#F59E0B` (Orange - new job notification)
- **Dark mode:** Auto-follow system preference

Icons

- Notification bell: 🔔
- Job: 📋
- Settings: ⚙️
- Link/Apply: 🔗
- Star/Track: ⭐

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7. MONETIZATION MODEL

Free Tier (MVP)

What's included:

- Up to 1 saved search
- Desktop notifications only
- Job history (7 days)
- Basic settings
- No Telegram
- No priority support

Pro Tier (₹199/month = ~$2.40)

What's included:

- Unlimited saved searches
- Desktop + Telegram notifications
- Job history (90 days)
- Email daily digest
- Priority refresh (2 min intervals)
- Basic job filtering (by budget)
- Email support

Premium Tier (₹499/month = ~$6)

What's included:

- Everything in Pro
- AI job scoring (Phase 2)
- AI proposal drafts (Phase 3)
- Advanced filtering (client rating, category)
- One-click apply (Phase 3)
- Analytics dashboard
- Telegram + Email support

Revenue Model

```
Pricing for India:
Free: ₹0
Pro: ₹199/month (~$2.40)
Premium: ₹499/month (~$6)

Global pricing (future):
Free: $0
Pro: $3.99/month
Premium: $9.99/month

Assumed conversion:
- 100 users in month 1
- 10% convert to Pro = ₹20K/month
- 5% convert to Premium = ₹25K/month
- Total MRR: ₹45K ($540/month)
```

Payment Processing

- Stripe (global)
- Razorpay (India)
- UPI for India (Phase 2)

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8. BUILD TIMELINE

Week 1: Core Extension

Days 1-2: Project Setup

- [ ] Create Manifest V3 file structure
- [ ] Set up GitHub repo
- [ ] Create initial popup.html, popup.js, background.js
- [ ] Create assets (icons, styles)

Days 3-4: Setup Wizard

- [ ] Build HTML form for Upwork URL input
- [ ] Save user settings to Chrome Storage
- [ ] Create settings page

Days 5-7: Job Monitoring

- [ ] Write DOM scraper for Upwork jobs
- [ ] Implement background script with 5-min refresh
- [ ] Detect new jobs (store/compare logic)

- [ ] Test scraper on real Upwork jobs

Week 2: Notifications & Polish

Days 8-10: Notifications

- [ ] Implement desktop notifications
- [ ] Add job history to popup
- [ ] One-click "Open in Upwork" button
- [ ] "Mark as Applied" tracking

Days 11-13: Polish & Testing

- [ ] Dark mode support
- [ ] Error handling (if Upwork page changes)
- [ ] Settings validation
- [ ] Manual testing on 10+ Upwork searches

Days 14: Release

- [ ] Create Chrome Web Store account
- [ ] Write description, screenshots, privacy policy
- [ ] Submit to Chrome Web Store review
- [ ] Wait for approval (3-7 days typically)

Week 3: Launch & Feedback

- [ ] Extension approved and live
- [ ] Post on r/Upwork, Twitter, LinkedIn
- [ ] Collect user feedback
- [ ] Fix bugs from user reports
- [ ] Start Phase 2 (backend API)

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9. TECHNICAL REQUIREMENTS

What We Need

```
Skill: JavaScript (required)
Framework: Vanilla JS (no React/Vue for MVP)
Browser: Chrome 130+ (MV3)
Tools: GitHub, VS Code, Chrome DevTools
Time: 80–100 hours (solo developer)
Hosting: Chrome Web Store (free)
Backend: None (MVP), Node.js (Phase 2)
Database: None (MVP), PostgreSQL (Phase 2)
```

Chrome Extension APIs Used

```
chrome.storage         → Save user settings
chrome.alarms          → Schedule refresh every X minutes
chrome.notifications   → Send notifications
chrome.tabs            → Open Upwork jobs
chrome.runtime         → Message passing
chrome.permissions     → Access to Upwork.com
```

Local Storage Structure

json

```
{
  "upworkUrl": "https://upwork.com/search/jobs/?q=python",
  "refreshInterval": 5,
  "notificationType": "desktop",
  "minBudget": 40,
  "telegramToken": "",
  "lastJobIds": ["12345", "12346", "12347"],
  "jobHistory": [
    {
      "id": "12347",
      "title": "Python Backend Dev",
      "budget": 50,
      "timestamp": "2026-10-25T10:30:00Z",
      "applied": false
    }
  ]
}
```

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10. RISKS & MITIGATION

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Upwork blocks DOM scraping	Extension stops working	Phase 2: Switch to official Upwork API (if available)
High false positives	Users disable notifications	Improve job filtering in Phase 2
Low conversion rate	No revenue	Target India with cheaper pricing ($2.40 vs $49)
Chrome Web Store rejects	Can't launch	Follow all policies: no auto-apply, no spam, clear privacy policy
Competitors copy idea	Less differentiation	Move fast to Phase 2 features (AI scoring, proposals)

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11. WHAT WE'RE NOT DOING (Yet)

- ❌ Official Upwork API (not available to new apps, Phase 2 workaround)
- ❌ AI job ranking (Phase 2)
- ❌ Auto-proposal generation (Phase 3)
- ❌ Email digests (Phase 2)
- ❌ Team features (Phase 4)
- ❌ Mobile app (Phase 4)
- ❌ Auto-connect/profile matching (too risky with Upwork ToS)

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12. SUCCESS CRITERIA (6 Months)

Month 1

- [ ] 100+ installs
- [ ] 4.5+ star rating
- [ ] 10+ paid users
- [ ] $500+ MRR

Month 3

- [ ] 1,000+ installs
- [ ] 50+ paid users
- [ ] $2,500+ MRR
- [ ] AI job scoring live (Phase 2)

Month 6

- [ ] 5,000+ installs
- [ ] 200+ paid users
- [ ] $10,000+ MRR
- [ ] AI proposals live (Phase 3)

NEXT STEPS

1. **Approve this PRD** - Confirm features and timeline
2. **Set up GitHub repo** - Start Week 1 development
3. **Create Manifest V3 boilerplate** - Begin coding
4. **Test on real Upwork searches** - Ensure scraper works
5. **Launch MVP** - Submit to Chrome Web Store

Questions? We can adjust features, timeline, or pricing based on your feedback.